25_MONETIZATION.md

UNPLND Monetization Strategy

Version 1.0

Priority: HIGH

Status: MVP

Purpose

Monetization should support the product.

Never define the product.

Users should happily pay because UNPLND creates value.

Not because they are forced.

Philosophy

Trust is more valuable than short-term revenue.

A user who loves UNPLND is worth more than a user who was pressured into subscribing.

Every monetization decision must answer:

"Does this still feel fair?"

If not,

do not implement it.

Revenue Streams

MVP

UNPLND Premium

Future

Partner Experiences

Affiliate Links

Travel Partners

Hotel Partners

Restaurant Partners

Event Partners

Experience Marketplace

API Access

White Label Solutions

Free Plan

Every free user can:

Create plans

Generate routes

Navigate

Create memory albums

Save favorites

Use Discover

Build memories

The core experience must remain free.

Premium

Premium enhances.

It never unlocks the purpose of the app.

Premium should feel like an upgrade.

Not a requirement.

Premium Benefits (MVP)

Unlimited AI generations

Advanced planning filters

Multiple alternative routes

Priority AI generation

Exclusive curated collections

Premium album themes

Extended planning history

Early access to new features

Future Premium

Collaborative planning

Shared premium albums

Travel mode

Weekend planner

Vacation planner

Adventure recap

Custom themes

AI personalization

Pricing Philosophy

Simple.

One subscription.

No confusing tiers.

No hidden limits.

Transparent billing.

Monthly

Yearly

Annual plan encouraged with fair savings.

Free Limits

Only soft limits.

Example

5 AI plans per week.

Afterwards

Wait

Or upgrade.

Albums remain unlimited.

Viewing old memories remains unlimited.

Never lock memories.

Paywall

Appears only when value has been demonstrated.

Never on first launch.

Never before first successful evening.

Users should understand Premium before seeing pricing.

Partner Content

Clearly labeled.

Never disguised as organic recommendations.

Sponsored experiences must still meet quality standards.

The Experience Engine always has priority.

Affiliate Links

Allowed only when they genuinely improve the experience.

Examples

Restaurant booking

Event tickets

Hotel booking

Activity reservations

Never recommend lower-quality experiences because of commission.

Advertising

No banner ads.

No fullscreen ads.

No rewarded ads.

No autoplay ads.

Advertising destroys trust.

Ethical Monetization

Never create fake urgency.

Never hide cancellation.

Never dark pattern users.

Never manipulate emotions.

Premium should feel optional.

Cancellation

Simple.

Transparent.

Immediate.

Users should respect UNPLND after cancelling.

Not feel trapped.

Student Pricing (Future)

Discounted subscription.

Verified.

Simple.

Family Plan (Future)

One subscription.

Multiple users.

Shared planning.

Shared albums.

Premium Design

Elegant.

Minimal.

Warm.

Premium screens should inspire.

Never pressure.

Premium Messages

Good

Unlock even more unforgettable evenings.

Bad

Upgrade NOW before it's too late!

Tone always remains human.

Business Partnerships

Future

Restaurants

Bars

Museums

Experiences

Hotels

Only partners matching UNPLND quality standards.

Success Metrics

Premium Conversion

Free Retention

Annual Subscription Rate

Cancellation Satisfaction

Partner Revenue

Album Sharing

Long-term trust is more important than short-term revenue.

DO NOT

Do NOT sell user data.

Do NOT sell precise location history.

Do NOT display intrusive ads.

Do NOT prioritize sponsored content over quality.

Do NOT lock users out of their memories.

Do NOT paywall the core experience.

Golden Rule

UNPLND earns money because users love it.

Not because users have no choice.

Claude Instructions

Every monetization feature must protect:

Trust

Simplicity

Transparency

User Experience

If revenue conflicts with experience,

experience always wins.

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